

There is a peculiar silence surrounding the suffering of men. Society has learned, rightly, to ask whether a woman is safe, whether she is hurting, whether she has someone to turn to. We have learned to recognize her pain as something deserving of attention. Yet when a man grows quiet, when his laughter becomes forced, when his eyes carry the exhaustion of battles he refuses to describe, we are often taught to see nothing at all.

We ask a man what he provides before we ask what he feels. We ask whether he is successful before we ask whether he is well. We praise him for enduring hardship, then wonder why he eventually breaks beneath it. His silence is mistaken for strength. His independence is mistaken

for contentment. His ability to carry others is mistaken for proof that he himself needs no one to carry him.

But a man is not made less human by being expected to be strong.

He still becomes lonely. He still becomes afraid. He still questions whether he is enough. He still lies awake at night wondering where his life went wrong, whether anyone would notice if he disappeared, or whether the people he loves would understand the weight he has been carrying. The fact that he may not speak these things does not mean they do not exist.

Perhaps one of society's greatest mistakes is believing that compassion is a limited resource, that caring deeply for

one group somehow requires caring less for another. It does not. The suffering of women deserves our attention, and so does the suffering of men. One does not diminish the other. Compassion does not become smaller when it is shared.

Men are worth asking about.

We are worth sitting beside when we have nothing to say. We are worth the uncomfortable conversations, the patience, the second chances, and the time it takes to understand what lies beneath our silence. We are worth more than our paychecks, our accomplishments, our usefulness, our strength, or the protection we provide to others.

A man should not have to collapse before someone realizes he was carrying too much.

And perhaps that is the change we should seek: not a world that cares less about anyone, but one that finally understands that men deserve to be cared about too.

Because behind every man society overlooks is a human being who, just like everyone else, wants to know that his existence matters.

And it does.

We are worth the effort.

We are worth the time.

We are worth being heard.

And we are worth being cared for, even before we break.